

MYLAPORE

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THE CLICKETY CLACK CONTINUES

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer **P4**



SCREEN TIME OFF FOR SENIORS TOO

In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft **P6**

Triplicane residents 'save' street from flooding

Following a protest by families at Easwardass Street, GCC stopped road-relaying work and revised the plan, revisiting the design



S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

Easwardass street in Triplicane on August 7.
PHOTO : RAGHUNATHAN SR

If residents of Easwardass Street in Triplicane had not put out a hand in an emphatic gesture of protest when a road-relaying work was initiated by Greater Chennai Corporation, they would have spent the ensuing months in dread of the upcoming North East Monsoon. In fact, they would be tasting the unsavoury fruit of that inaction much earlier if Chennai's secondary monsoon, the South West Monsoon engineered a cloudburst.

Fortunately, this sad state of affairs is not going to pan out. There was no inaction. The hands had gone up in protest, politely but firmly.

Easwardass Street residents stopped an exercise by Zone 9 of GCC to lay a layer of interlocking

cement bricks over a pre-existing cement layer on their street. They brought the work to a halt, raising the issue of lack of storm-water drainage. Cemented years ago, the street could have that layer interlocking cement bricks only as a replacement for the cement layer and not as an addition to it. Already lacking an effective water channel to drain water, this would have further "sealed" the street turning it into a trough for rainwater.

Following pressure from residents, Zone 9 GCC authorities called off the work and began removing the bricks that had already been laid. The revised plan is to first strip away the existing cemented layer and then relay the road with interlocking bricks, this time with proper drainage

provisions.

Madhavan, a retired government employee and resident, explained that the road is very narrow and had already been raised on account of a cement layer laid earlier, leaving no slope or channel for rainwater to drain.

"Every time it rains, the water does not drain; it just sits and slowly evaporates, taking days to disappear," he says.

He adds that the fresh attempt to lay interlocking cement bricks without addressing the drainage issue was even more frustrating. After he and a few other residents formally raised their concerns, an inspection was carried out, the paving work stopped, and the authorities began removing the newly laid blocks.



Madras Day: a tree walk at May Day park

To celebrate Madras Day, the Photographic Society of Madras is conducting a photo contest. 'Shoot Madras' is open to all and will be held in two categories (general and student). Participants must shoot images on one of these themes: Chennai

Festivals, Architecture of Chennai and Chennai Daily Life. Last date for submission is August 12.

For details, visit <https://thema-drasday.in>

Nizhal is conducting tree walks at various venues in the city. On August 15, the walk will begin at 4.30 p.m. at May Day park; on August 16 at Egmore Museum campus at 7.30 a.m. To register, call 9445028067

Need help in conducting an event for Madras Day, WhatsApp 98410 49155

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Broken SWD covers at CIT Colony



RAMDAS NAIK

On CIT Colony First Main Road, almost all cement cover lids on the stormwater drain openings are broken and have not been replaced for a few years. Branches are placed as warning instead. On 6th Cross and 1st Link Street, an SWD drain opening seems to be around six inches lower than the road level, resembling a pothole as the road was relaid without proper milling before the elections.

The AE GCC had promised to rectify it after the new administration took office, but nothing has happened so far. All the streets in



the colony was relaid a few months before the election and most of the streets have been dug up now by various agencies.

Ramdas Naik is secretary CIT RWA in Mylapore



The junction of Bazullah Road and Raghavaiah Road in T. Nagar.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Representational picture

Pavements on Sivaswamy Salai **hardly usable**

SRIRAM J

Footpaths on both sides of Sivaswamy Salai in Mylapore (from Valluvar Salai end to Vivekananda College) are not accessible to pedestrians.

estrians.

Luxury cars/cabs running tour business, two and four wheeler service mechanics, roadside eateries have completely occupied the footpath.

Irony is Sivaswamy Salai's footpath was widened by almost five feet for use by pedestrians because this road is very busy with traffic from early morning till late night, but because of encroachment, seniors like me are forced to walk on the road.

Also, this is a declared one-way road from Nageswara Rao park to Valluvar Salai junction, but who cares. It has become a two-way road. After sunset, it gets worse. With blinding head lights on, people cannot see properly.

El station resembles a **garage**

BASKAR SESHADRI

El Police Station in Mylapore resembles a garage. Two-wheelers towed by the police are dumped here.

Vehicles seized for various offences including hit-and-run, drug trafficking and drunken driving are left here.

As the procedure to dispose of

such vehicles is protracted and arduous, these vehicles gather dust.

A police official who wished to remain anonymous said that such a huge space could be better utilised with a small canteen, restrooms and dormitory for outstation police staff who come to work in Mylapore.

Baskar Seshadri is a resident of Mylapore



'Vendors demand money from motorists'



RAGU V.

Recently when I was trying to park my two-wheeler at Parry's Corner in what appeared to be a public parking area, a woman selling flowers stopped me. She had placed her basket in the parking space and demanded ₹20 from me for parking there.

When I questioned her, she outrightly told me to pay the amount or take away my vehicle. This caused considerable inconvenience for me. This is the stretch opposite Parry's Corner police station, near the flower market.

It appears that certain roadside vendors are illegally occupying public parking spaces and collecting money from motorists. Such activities inconvenience the public and create unnecessary confrontations. I request the authorities to investigate the matter and remove any illegal encroachments.

Ragu V. is a resident of Bangaru Street, Ayanavaram

'Key junction needs **mending**'

GANESAN GANAPATHI

The junction of Bazullah Road and Raghavaiah Road in T. Nagar is battered and therefore conducive for waterlogging. Besides, traffic movement slows down here. This junction witnesses heavy traffic; therefore the road should be well maintained.

Ganesan Ganapathi is a resident of T. Nagar.



You can be our **volunteer writer**

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.

▼
The flyover at Peters Road - Conran Smith Road junction. PHOTO. RAGU R



Focus on ‘underbellies’ of flyovers

The flyover at Peters Road-Conran Smith Road junction and the ones near Music Academy and Narada Gana Sabha are part of this project

R. RAGU

What verandahs are to sprawling bungalows, spaces-under-flyovers are to major roads. They catch the eye more than anything else, and help form an opinion of the rest of the house as well as the

road. The spaces under flyovers in Chennai have often fared poorly, showcasing squalor more than beauty despite so-called beautification efforts. From time to time, residents have been witness to vertical gardens wilting and then progressively going from bad to worse, the containers going

empty with the plants in them doing a Houdini-like disappearing act. Against this backdrop, it is heartening to note that Greater Chennai Corporation is taking a fresh look at these prominent spaces. GCC's Special Projects Wing is set to revamp the underbellies of 10 flyovers into usable public spaces with

parks, walking tracks and parking lots with EV charging facilities.

A peek into the list

The space under the Peters Road - Conran Smith Road flyover gives an inkling of what is to come. According to someone associated with Greater Chennai

Corporation and familiar with the development, the other flyovers that come under this new project include the flyover near Music Academy, the flyover near Narada Gana Sabha, the flyover in Mahalingapuram, the flyover near Government Museum in Egmore and the new flyover on North Usman Road.

New entrance gateway at MCC school in Chetpet



▼
During the inaugural event on August 1. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A new entrance gateway has been constructed at Madras Christian College Higher Secondary School in Chetpet through the generous contributions of the alumni who studied at the school in 1975.

The gateway featuring an elegant clock tower and the school's name plaque, was formally inaugurated on August 1, 2026.

The newly constructed gateway was dedicated by K. M. Mammen, chairman of the M.C.C. Association, in the presence of alumni, members of the school management, staff, and invited guests, says a press release.

The new entrance gateway stands as a lasting symbol of the enduring bond between the school and its alumni, reflecting their gratitude and commitment to the continued growth and development of their alma mater, the release adds.

The clickety clack continues



LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A chorus of clickety-clacks from manual typewriters drowns the bustle on Jagannathapuram First Street, which sits in a tract of Chetpet where every house leans into the next somewhat like books in a library shelf. Inside, as young fingers dance over ageing manual typewriters, kept sprightly by consistent maintenance, teacher-plus-owner of Chetpet Typewriting Institute (est. 1975) P. Padmanabhan is supervising yet another class, spelling out instructions to students.

Typing proficiency opening doors to certain clerical positions in government and private settings, being an essential component in certain competitive government exams including TNPSC Group IV, certain categories of Staff Selection Commission, institutes of this nature still thrive. Padmanabhan points out every class includes students who see typing skill as an end in itself. Therefore, also expect those training for careers in law, the corporate world and so on to walk in through those doors.

And these multiple needs keep these instruments going, refur-



P. Padmanabhan at Chetpet Typewriting Institute; and (below) typewriter mechanic S. Thyagarajan.

2006, taking the mantle from his father and running Chetpet Typewriting Institute. The institute operating from a space in Padmanabhan's house, makes the overheads of running it manageable. He notes with quiet pride, "I am a certified high-speed typewriting expert and an official government examiner," recognised by the Ta-

mil Nadu Directorate of Technical Education (DoTE). With 50 students at present, Padmanabhan personally teaches both Tamil and English typewriting; shorthand classes are also offered. His voice resonating with justifiable pride, he says: "Search my name online, you will find it."

Certainly, decades ago, every street probably sported a typewriting institute. Those like Padmanabhan maintain their numbers would have dwindled, but their relevance has not been eroded. And this is why, 20 years after retirement, he continues to fill his house with a chorus of clickety-clacks.

'Rescuing' typewriters

The phone rings, and within minutes, 54-year-old S. Thyagarajan is on his way to 'rescue' another manual typewriter. There is no workshop, no colourful signboards announcing his trade. He is the workshop on the move; and his experience repairing manual

typewriters since 1986 is the signboard. Owners of typewriting institutes across Chennai have his number saved as "ICE". That is obviously hyperbole, but typewriter mechanics such as Thyagarajan are indeed indispensable in "emergency" situations involving these machines, as brands selling manual typewriters have long ceased production, and the old machines have to be kept in circulation. Thyagarajan entered the profession soon after completing Class 10, having been born into a family of typewriter mechanics, his grandfather and uncle particularly known in the trade. The clatter of these machines defines his earliest memories, and he is among a dedicated group of people who refuse to let manual typewriters become a memory. While typewriter manufacturers have ceased production, he says typewriters are far from extinction. "The spare parts still come from Delhi. A manufacturer who started the business when typewriters were in their heyday continues to supply them to this day," he explains.

He notes that around 40 regular customers, including several typewriting institutes still rely on his services. Thyagarajan once ran repair shops which he shut down as rents escalated. "Every occupation evolves with time. One phone is enough now to run your business," he says.

He is a staunch believer not only in these machines, but also what they bring to the table, well sheet. He is emphatic those trained on typewriters make fewer mistakes because their fingers develop greater typing accuracy than those who learn typing directly on computer keyboards, particularly while typing Indian languages such as Tamil. "Even my name has been misspelt umpteen number of times," he remarks bitterly, adding that such mistakes can create unnecessary complications in government records. And for that reason and also for the fact that livelihoods still depend on typewriting institutes, he wants these old machines to continue clicking away in classrooms and examination halls.

bished from time to time. Chetpet Typewriting Institute is not the oldest, but is symbolic of typewriting institutes continuing despite challenges from technology.

Padmanabhan belabours typewriting institutes' continuing relevance, citing numbers and benefits. "There are 4,200 government-approved typewriting institutes across Tamil Nadu," he states. "Typewriting equips a person to type faster and more efficiently. Once you master it, operating a computer becomes effortless."

This belief has had Padmanabhan, now aged 75, wearing a new hat post his retirement as medical photo officer (also known as 'medical photographer') from Rajiv Gandhi Government Hospital in

A plea to the Tamil Nadu government

Typewriting institutes are anxious over a government order dated October 28, 2024 stating that the Department of Technical Education (DoTE) in Tamil Nadu would be doing away with the practice of having typing exams on manual typewriters, shifting them to computers from February 2028. Echoing the collective sentiment of associations representing typewriting institutes across the state, J. Srinivasan of Karumari Technical Institute in Saidapet, told The Hindu Downtown that typewriting exams in English and Tamil should be conducted only on typewriters. He points out, "Besides, the Computer on Office Automation (COA) exam should not be merged with the English and Tamil typewriting exams. Instead, the current system of conducting the three exams separately with a separate certificate given for each should continue. Every year, more than one lakh students take typing exams, conducted every six months. Clubbing them with COA will reduce the number of takers; and that will result in reduced revenue for the government." Srinivasan adds that switching typing exams from manual typewriters to computers will affect the livelihoods of typewriting institutes and typewriter mechanics across Tamil Nadu, which he estimates around 5000 and 2000 respectively. He states: "Associations and federations representing these institutes and mechanics want this GO cancelled."

A Fight For Survival
In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at an old industry that is pitted against new technology

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers since Madras became Chennai, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer



ERR

In focus: Elevator Safety 101

If the lift in your apartment gets stuck often, it is time to check when its license was last renewed

LIFFY THOMAS

In the last one year, how many times have you or a family member got stranded in a lift in your residential building?

Of the 1,540 responses from Chennai residents that LocalCircles received to this question, 48% said they were fortunate not to get stuck; 25% were unfortunate to have that unsavoury experience once or twice.

Just like elevators in public spaces and mass transit facilities such as MRTS stations, those at apartment communities can show their malfunctioning machine side, frustrating residents. When an elevator malfunctions in any setting, private or public, and causes a safety threat to users, who are the entities one pins the blame on?

Going by a recent Supreme Court ruling, the ma-

nufacturer, the maintenance agency and the owner of the premises are jointly liable for any breach of the safety of lift users.

A pan-India study by community social media platform LocalCircles found 33% had no confidence in the safety of lifts installed in their building. Close to 32% of the respondents from Chennai said the lift in their community was maintained by the lift manufacturer via annual maintenance contract (AMC); another 37% said lifts were maintained by a third party via AMC; 20% said no regular maintenance, only repairs based on issues.

Although the Tamil Nadu Lift Rules

Act, 1997 got amended this year, accountability is still raised only after a lift malfunctions or an accident happens. Many lifts continue to function without license renewal.

Challenges to inspection

In fact, identifying lifts functioning without a valid licence is a big challenge faced by the Electrical Inspectorate, a department under the Government of Tamil Nadu. Besides other functions, the department is responsible for issuing of permission for lifts and escalators to be installed and for the renewal of licenses.

As per the Tamil Nadu Lifts and Escalators (Amendment) Act, 2025, which came into effect in February 2026, license for lifts has to be renewed once in five years.

V. Ramakrishnan, chief electrical inspector to the State Government, says they previously used to send reminders to buildings for renewal, but now that the process is "auto generated" they stopped.

Renewal process

can be done online and must be initiated three months before it expires. The average fee for renewal and penalty for late payment is a small sum, a reason why many buildings ignore it.

The renewal process is important to identify defects and take up preventive steps before a compliance report is submitted

"It is not possible to keep inspecting buildings that have not renewed their licence as there are hundreds of buildings with this facility, but based on complaints we do random checks," says Ramakrishnan, adding that the public can bring it to the department's notice.

Recently, when passengers were trapped in a lift at Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station, the department sent out its team to inspect it.

Besides shortage in manpower, the Department is often faced with issues among residents in apartment associations who derail the process for renewal.

The official says that very recently at an apartment in Chennai the secretary of the association had applied for renewal but the president called to complain that the exercise was taken up without approval of a majority of residents.

"In apartments, there is conflict among residents as those on the ground floor do not want to pay for lift charges and renewal, so we are asked to intervene," he says.

For complaints and other issues, email ceig@tn.gov.in and ceig@tn.nic.in



Paying a premium to ensure safe lifts

This gated community in Manapakkam allocates a huge sum every year for the maintenance of its elevators

Casagrand Irene, a gated community in Manapakkam with 295 flats spread across 15 blocks and 13 villas, has ensured lift-related complaints are kept to a minimum by paying a premium for the maintenance of lifts.

"We spend 4-5 percent of our total revenue in lift maintenance, which translates to around ₹ 10.5 lakh annually," says Lebbaeus Denis, secretary, Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association.

Under a contract with Schneider Electricals, the Association has signed up for Diamond Category Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC), which is the highest in the plan, gold and silver being the other two categories.

In the diamond category, all spare parts including battery

come under unlimited warranty. Every year, the company also undertakes a pre-maintenance schedule in which they replace most of the parts in the functioning of the lift. Besides, what is mandated by the manufacturer, once in every two years the Association replaces the batteries as well, especially in blocks where lifts see more wear and tear.

"There are two batteries in one lift, each costing ₹13,000. The life a battery lasts three years but as a precautionary measure we schedule the replacement a little before the cut-off time," says Denis.

Besides checks every month, the community just needs to raise a complaint in a software and in three hours the technical team arrives to fix the issue.

As in many communities where owners of flats on the ground floor complain about paying for an amenity they rarely use, this community has faced this situation. With villas also dotting the community, they have a big voice against spiralling bills on lift maintenance.

Denis feels that expenditure will keep coming but Associations need to find alternative revenue streams. "We have allotted space for digital ads kept outside the lift that give us ₹ 6 lakh revenue a year, this way we are incurring a more manageable expense on lift maintenance and at the same time ensuring residents have little to complain about," says the secretary.



SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

When conversations around screen addiction come up, they almost always centre on children and teenagers. But what about the adults who spend their workdays peering into laptops, unwind by scrolling through social media, and end the day glued to the television screen?

Here is the outline of an answer to that. And it is being sketched by The Kraft Faktor, a small-batch handmade products brand, creating soaps, shampoos, perfumes, candles and home fragrances, that has over time tucked an experience-based initiative into the shopping bag, conducting craft-based workshops, curating personalised gifts and developing DIY kits for people to continue crafting at home.

Deepa Sam and Nabeela Rehman, founders of The Kraft Faktor (TKF), view digital overload as cutting across demographic divides. TKF has inked in a couple of small-batch workshops (Mindful Line Art & Pattern Making and Paper Alchemy - Beginner-friendly Decoupage) for August 15 (11 a.m. to 1 p.m.) at Playbae Cafe in Thoraipakkam that indirectly address screen addiction. For participation, the number of birthdays someone has had so far carries little weight. For additional details about the workshop, DM them on Insta @thekraftfaktor.

These workshops have a philosophical underpinning, simple but far-reaching.

"We are saying: consciously build a habit in your 20s and 30s of practising some form of art or craft every day," says Deepa. "It could be anything. It could simply be cooking a meal or consciously grooming yourself. If these small routines are done consciously, the results are not visible in one or two days, but over time they make a difference."

Participants of TKF's workshops range from young professionals looking for a break from busy work schedules to retirees trying to fill the void that often follows decades of routine. "We noticed that this stage of life often leaves a huge vacuum," says Deepa. "Many people naturally fall into digital consumption."

For the founders, the concern is not simply the amount of time

Screen addiction is disproportionately associated with children and teenagers, adults often being a glaring omission. In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft

Screen time off for seniors too



people spend online. It is the way screens constantly compete for attention. "For me, it is very simply put – overstimulation versus correct stimulation," Deepa says. "On a screen there are hundreds of images and notifications. Even if you are only watching a few posts or one reel, you generally do not stop because social media is designed to keep you hooked."

Here is the contrast TKF seeks to drive home through its workshops.

"When you are creating a craft with your hands, your brain focuses on one task for 15-20 minutes. You are following one process, one sequence, one goal. There is also a natural stopping point. You finish one page, one piece or one step," Deepa adds.

Unlike scrolling through an endless stream of content, craft requires people to interact with real materials, making decisions, changing tack and reviewing the output. Paper has to be folded. Wax has to be poured. Glue has to be applied. Hands move objects, feel textures and respond to the material in front of them. Instead of reacting to rapidly changing colours, movement and notifications, attention stays with one activity at a time.

Nabeela elaborates: "With doomscrolling, you are only taking in information. Every second you are absorbing something new. When you are doing an activity, you are constantly asking yourself, 'What next? How can I do this? Is there a better way than last time?' There's a give-and-take in the process."

Mindfulness is a healthy by-product. Someone who makes things regularly is also more likely to think carefully about what they buy, how they use materials and whether something can be repaired, reused or repurposed instead of discarded.

The workshops themselves are intentionally small, with no more than eight participants at a time. A DIY kit is part of what every workshop offers, making it easier for participants to keep practising long after the session ends.



From a line art workshop; and the result of a decoupage exercise.

Pinkathon spotlights preventive healthcare for women in Chennai



The Zydus Pinkathon was held at the Island Grounds in Chennai on Sunday to promote women's health, fitness and preventive healthcare.

As per a press release, the event featured race categories ranging from 3 km, 5 km and 10 km to ultra-distance events of 50 km, 75 km and 100 km. Over 3,000 women were said to have participated in the event, including first-time runners, cancer survivors, visually impaired runners, babywearing mothers and senior citizens.

A hair donation drive was or-

ganised as part of the event, where several participants donated their hair to be used for making wigs for cancer patients. The event also highlighted breast cancer awareness through Zydus Lifesciences' "The Easiest Exam" campaign, which encourages women to perform regular self-breast examinations for early detection.

Pinkathon founder Milind Soman said the initiative aims to create an inclusive platform that encourages women from all walks of life to adopt healthier lifestyles and prioritise preventive healthcare.

Essay competition on eye donation

In observance of National Eye Donation Fortnight, TwinTech Healthcare Services, a unit of the TwinTech Institute of Education Trust is conducting a essay competition on the theme "Donate Eyes, Gift Sight, and Give Life."

The competition is open to all.

The essay can be in English or Tamil not exceeding 1,500 words, highlighting the importance of eye donation, its impact on individuals and society, and innovative ways to motivate people to pledge their eyes.

Details about the participant such as full name, age, complete postal address, along with a brief profile should be mentioned.

Participants are expected to submit original essays and AI-generated entries will be disqualified without any notice, says a press release.

The initiative aims to spread awareness about the importance of eye donation and encourage people to pledge their eyes as that would help restore sight to individuals affected by corneal blindness, through the priceless gift of eye donation.

The last date for submission of the essay is August 15 by 5 p.m. to the following email: chennai.twintech@gmail.com

The winners will be announced on August 20.

For details, participants may contact Dr. A. Mahalingam through WhatsApp: 97104 85295.

Bring your old zari sari to Rasi Silks

Rasi Silks (Radha Silk Emporium), which was established in 1900, offers a comprehensive shopping experience for the entire family. Its portal <https://rasisilks.com> displays a magnificent collection from signature Kancheepuram pure silk saris to lightweight cottons, Po-champally and Banaras weaves, said a release.

The portal also features a dedicated, premium segment of ethnic wear for men, designed for weddings, festivals and formal gatherings. The classic men's kurta is meticulously tailored from pure silk and fine cotton, featuring both subtle, minimalist designs and intricate traditional motifs.

The portal is secure for online payments, added the release.

The Mylapore-based outlet is



having an old sari exchange initiative. Customers can bring in their heirloom, old pure zari saris for evaluation, and upgrade their wardrobes with stunning new drapes.

RMKV's new collection inspired by Japanese culture

RMKV Silks, known for its wedding saris and silk saris, has launched a range of exclusive handwoven saris inspired by Japanese heritage and culture, 'Kumo Korvai', 'Mt Fuji', and 'Sashiko Reversible'.

The saris, known for their pioneering designs and advanced weaving techniques, have earned the brand two national awards, a Guinness World Record, and several patents, according to a release from the enterprise.

The store has partnered with the Central Silk Board to develop a modernised pneumatic handloom, an innovation designed to reduce the physical strain of weaving while enabling artisans to better use their skills and enhance productivity. By making the weaving process less labour-intensive, the initiative has also encouraged greater participation of women in the craft, creating new opportunities while preserving the essence of traditional handloom weaving, the release added.

The store is renowned for its naturally dyed silk saris and patented 40 percent lighter 'Lino' silk saris, the grand reversible sari, and the world's longest theme-silk sari, the release said.

105th Annual Day celebrated

Four schools under the Shri Sanatana Dharma Vidyalaya Association came together at Narada Gana Sabha

The 105th Annual Day celebration of Shri Sanatana Dharma Vidyalaya Association of S.S.D.V. Mat.Hr.Sec. School, M.F.S.D.Hr.Sec. School, K.A. Bal Niketan School, Shakthi Public School was celebrated on August 5 at Narada Gana Sabha, Alwarpet.

R. K. Jhaver, Ashok Kumar Mundhra, Vijay Goel, Gopal Agarwal, K. K. Maheshwari, S. P. Baheti, Vijay Maheshwari, R. S. Mundhra, R. C. Daga, S. M. Damani were among those present.

Meenakshi Ramesh, CEO of Pratham Education Foundation, was the chief guest.

K. K. Maheshwari, gener-

al secretary, said the 105th Annual Day Celebration was not only a celebration of the institution's glorious legacy but also an occasion to reaffirm its enduring values.

Principals of all four schools— S. Latha (SSDV), Ananthakrishnan (MFSD), Meethu Sahadev (KAB), and Yadla Nagalakshmi (SPS)—presented their respective annual reports. They highlighted the outstanding academic performance of their schools, including the SSLC and Higher Secondary Board Examination results, school toppers, centum achievers, and subject-wise distinctions. The reports also showcased the wide range of co-curricular and

extracurricular activities organised throughout the academic year, remarkable achievements secured by students in various inter-school competitions, Olympiads, sports meets, and cultural events, reflecting the institutions' commitment to holistic education and all-round student development, said a release.

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PLAN YOUR WEEK

Songs from
Kishore Kumar

Satrangi's next presentation 'Kaptivating Kishore' will be held on August 9, 2026 at Teach Auditorium, Taramani.

Presented by Promod and Smriti on pre recorded tracks, this programme will feature evergreen songs of the legendary singer Kishore Kumar from 1950s to 1980s. Tickets for this event are priced at ₹500 and ₹300 and will be home delivered on calling 9884778073.

Aadi Vizha at
Bhavan's

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan is conducting Aadi Vizha from August 10 to 14 at its main auditorium in Mylapore. The series includes Harikatha, musical discourses, Villupaattu and Bakthi Padalgal. The programmes scheduled includes discourse by Nagai Mukundan on Kandhan Karunai on August 10, 6.30 p.m.; Villupaattu by Bharathi Thirumagan on Aadi Katril Amman Ula on August 11, 6.30 pm; Musical Discourse by Suchitra on Entha Ruchira Rama on August 12, 6.30 pm; Namasankirthanam by Udaiyalur Kalyanaraman on August 13, 6.30 pm; and Bakthi Padalgal by Veeramani Raju on August 14, 6.30 pm. All events are open to all.

Cooperative societies at Kalaivanar Arangam



To mark National Handloom Day (August 7), Co-optex's *Vetri Thari* special sale and HANDTEX 2026 exhibition is happening at Kalaivanar Arangam till August 13. Visitors can purchase a wide range of traditional handloom products made by cooperative societies of Tamil Nadu. PHOTO: B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Celebrating art



The main exhibition of Contemporary Now - Edition III is happening at Lalit Kala Akademi till August 25. The organisers invite the public to be a part of this event that has brought together leading galleries, artists, institutions and audiences across Chennai to strengthen India's contemporary art ecosystem.

The event continues with exhibitions and public programmes across Chennai, inviting audiences to experience contemporary art through multiple perspectives, spaces and conversations.

Programmes are happening at Ashvita's Campus, Alliance Française of Madras, Raw Mango, Apparao Galleries and Gallery Veda.

Nominate a teacher that made a difference

Mission Guru Devo Bhava, in association with the Lions Club of Meenambakkam, invites nominations for the third edition of Vidhya Seva Samman.

The initiative aims to honour teachers who have gone beyond the classroom, inspired their students, nurtured values and made a genuine difference to their lives.

Anil Kitcha, in a press note, says the initiative hopes to build a tradition through which society respectfully thanks teachers and whose influence extends far beyond the classroom and transformed the lives of their students and strengthened communities.

This year, the organisers propose to honour 10 deserving teachers from schools across Chennai. Each awardee will receive a cash award of ₹50,000, a citation and a memento.

Schools, parents, students, teachers and members of the public can nominate a teacher that truly deserves a recognition.

The late date to nominate in August 15, 2026. The awards will be presented on September 6, 2026 at the DAV Girls Senior Secondary School auditorium, Gopalapuram.

For details, visit tinyurl.com/vssteacher-nomination

Chettinad Vidyashram hosts 11th edition of legal symposium

Bala Vidya Mandir, Adyar and PS Senior Secondary School secure top places

Bala Vidya Mandir, Adyar was adjudged Best School in the Senior Symposium and PS Senior Secondary School secured the Best School Award in Moot Court at the 11th edition of Legis Festis hosted by Chettinad Vidyashram.

The annual legal symposium was held on July 30 at Kumararajah Muthiah Hall. Held in memory of the school's beloved correspondent Meena Muthiah, the event brought together students from leading schools across

Chennai to celebrate legal awareness, critical thinking and ethical advocacy under the theme Veritas Semper Vincit (Truth Always Conquers), said a release.

The symposium was inaugurated with an invocation followed by a welcome address by president Saikrishna Vijay and secretary A. Deeksha.

R. John Sathyan, Senior Advocate and State Public Prosecutor and S. Selva Sundari, Secretary, High Court Legal Services Committee were the special guests.

Principal S. Amudha Lakshmi emphasised the importance of legal literacy in shaping responsible citizens, while Vice-Principal James Allwin urged participants to pursue excellence with perseverance and ethical conviction.

